

# Supplementary Material for the Paper: “How to Probe Sentence Embeddings in Low-Resource Languages: On Structural Design Choices for Probing Task Evaluation”

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## A Quality of Machine Translated Data

|       | BLEU (1-gram) | METEOR | MoverScore |
|-------|---------------|--------|------------|
| en-ka | 0.271         | 0.149  | 0.272      |
| en-ru | 0.470         | 0.335  | 0.353      |
| en-tr | 0.493         | 0.359  | 0.398      |
| en-de | 0.446         | 0.342  | 0.337      |

Table 1: Quality of the machine translation service used to translate training data for downstream tasks on reference datasets.

We automatically translated the input data for the AM and TREC downstream tasks. To estimate the quality of the machine translated data, we measured the performance of the service used to translate the data with the help of the JW300 corpus (Agić and Vulić, 2019; Tiedemann, 2012). For each of the language pairs en-ka, en-tr, and en-ru, we translated the first 10,000 sentences of the respective bitext files from JW300 and measured their quality in terms of BLEU, METEOR and MoverScore (Zhao et al., 2019).<sup>1</sup> As reference, we also added en-de as a pair with two well-resourced languages. Results are summarized in Table 1. They show that, with the exception of en-ka, all language pairs have high-quality translations (on par or even better than en-de). We thus expect the influence of errors of the machine translated data to be minimal in tr and ru. For ka, this is not necessarily the case.

## B Sentence Encoder Dimensions

Table 2 shows the full list of encoders used in our study and their dimensionalities.

## C Class Imbalance

In addition to the classifier type and size, we also tested the influence of the class (im)balance of the

<sup>1</sup>Misaligned sentences were skipped.

| Encoder              | Size |
|----------------------|------|
| Avg                  | 300  |
| pmeans (Avg+Max+Min) | 900  |
| Random LSTM          | 4096 |
| InferSent            | 4096 |
| QuickThought         | 2400 |
| LASER                | 1024 |
| BERT                 | 768  |

Table 2: Encoders and their dimensionalities.

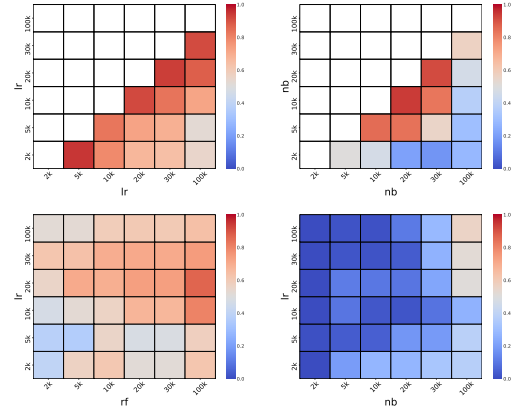


Figure 1: Top: Average correlations  $\text{sim}_c(s, t)$  for LR (left) and NB (right), using Spearman. Bottom: Average correlations  $\text{sim}_{c,d}(s, t)$  for  $c = \text{LR}$  and  $d = \text{RF}$  (left) and  $c = \text{LR}$  and  $d = \text{NB}$  (right).

|     | LR        | RF        | NB         |
|-----|-----------|-----------|------------|
| MLP | .531/.777 | .312/.564 | -.071/.205 |
| LR  |           | .362/.602 | -.107/.147 |
| RF  |           |           | -.111/.287 |

Table 3: Min/Avg values  $\text{sim}_{c,d}(s, t)$  across  $(s, t)$  (using Spearman) between classifiers  $c$  and  $d$ .

training data. In particular, for the four binary probing tasks BigramShift, SubjNumber, SV-Agree, and Voice, we examine the effect of imbalancing with ratios of 1:5 and 1:10. We use LR with sizes of 10k, 20k, and 30k training instances and correlate